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EDI APPLICATION INTERFACE

Version 3.5.2

Product Guide



FRONTISPIECE

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This product information relates to:

EDI Application Interface Version 3.5.2

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Glossary



Glossary

ANA

Article Number Association. The Standards Organisation responsible for the support and development of the Tradacoms message standard.

Application Interface

A System 21 application which extracts documents to be sent to a Trading Partner via EDI and adds them into EDI/400 for translation and transmission.

Conversely, it updates System 21 with information from documents received via EDI/400.

ANSI X.12

A message standard developed by the American National Standards Institute. Widely used in the United States.

Code Translation

An operation performed by EDI/400 to translate an Element's Standard Code into a code defined to System 21. Also used to translate a Trading Partner's code for an element into the System 21 code for the same element, and vice-versa.

Control List

A System 21 Application Interface report providing details of Documents to be sent or received via EDI.

Data Segments

See Element.

Document

In EDI this is an electronic business transaction made up of Segments. Also known as a Message or Transaction Set.

EAN

European Article Number

EDI

Electronic Data Interchange. A method of transmitting business information over a Network, between Trading Partners who agree to follow approved national or industry standards in translating and exchanging information.

EDI/400

A PREMENOS module which receives standard Documents from a Network, translates them and adds them into the System 21 Application Interface database.

Conversely, it translates Documents output from the Application Interface into standard Documents. It then sends the Documents to a private or third party network.

EDIFACT

Electronic Data Interchange For Administration, Commerce and Transport. This is a message standard developed within the United Nations.

Element

A single item of data within a Transaction Set. Combined elements form data segments.

Lockbox

Receive notification from your bank that cash has been paid into your account. Payment advice and remittance information (Tradacoms document type ANSI 823) is processed, validated and received from your bank via EDI.

Lockbox (non EDI) operates in the Cash Management module as the AR Interface Posting option to process valid receipts from your bank on magnetic tape.

Mailbox

An area on an EDI network services computer that holds a customer's transactions. It also allows the customer to send to multiple receivers in a single session.

Mailbox Queue

The component of EDI/400 that combines outgoing transactions and receives incoming transactions.

Mapping

Shows the relationship between Segments and Elements in a standard document and fields in the System 21 Application Interface database.

Message

See Document.

Message Standard

A pre-defined format that allows business partners with incompatible internal formats to exchange documents electronically. The major standards include ANSI X.12, EDIFACT and Tradacoms.

Network

A public or private telecommunications network which is used together with an EDI network services computer to provide an EDI solution for customers to exchange Documents.

ODETTE

A message standard much used in the automotive industry.

Parallel Running

An initial period of time where trading partners agree to exchange documents electronically, but still retain a printed version of the documents for back-up purposes.

SDQ

Specified Destination Quantity.

Segment

A pre-defined set of functionally related Data Elements, identified by an initial three-character code.

Standard

See Message Standard.

Standard Code

A pre-defined method of representing commonly needed information with a short, unambiguous set of characters.

Standard Document

See Document.

Tradacoms

A message standard developed and supported in the UK by the ANA.

Trading Partner

A Customer or Supplier with whom there is an agreement to exchange documents electronically.

Transaction Set

See Document.

Translation

The process of converting data between a standard format and an internal format.

Translation Map

See Mapping.

User File Definition

The description of the record in the Application Interface database. These exist for incoming and outgoing documents in the EDI/400 application. Includes file name, length, position and attribute of each field.

VAN

Value Added Network. See Network.

VDA

Verband Der Automobilindustrie - The German Automotive Industry Association.

The VDA maintain its own EDI standards: this is a series of fixed format messages that describe business documents typically exchanged between automotive manufacturers and suppliers.

Nearly all German automotive manufacturers belong to the VDA so if you do business with the German Automotive Industry you are likely to need to translate its messages. However, the VDA are in the process of migrating to ODETTE and EDIFACT so within a few years a more consistent change should emerge.

All the standards are published in German, because at its conception international traffic was not perceived.

Unlike other EDI standards there is no naming convention within the VDA specifications for each element. Therefore there is a reliance on the German text and the foreign language interpretation to uniquely identify it. It is likely that each host will require their own internal naming convention, such as a four character numeric code.

Its fixed record format does not lend itself to easy conversion to an existing dialect such as EDIFACT or X.12.

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